

QA LEADERSHIP ACADEMY

Module 7 Assignment — Metrics That Actually Matter

Assignment brief: scenario, deliverables, steps and how your work is assessed.

About this assignment

Northstar currently reports the number of test cases and the number of bugs found — and almost nothing about escaped defects, change failure rate or customer impact, even though production defects are trending up. Priya wants data-driven conversations, the CTO wants a view he can take to the board, and your own team needs operational signals. You have been asked to design a metrics framework that serves all three audiences without descending into vanity numbers.

What you'll demonstrate

- Choose metrics that reflect quality outcomes, not testing activity
- Design distinct dashboards for distinct audiences
- Define each metric precisely enough to be trusted
- Retire vanity metrics and explain why they mislead

What to submit

- A Quality Metrics Framework for Northstar
- Three dashboards — QA team, engineering leadership and executive — with an explanation of why each differs
- Metric Definition Templates for the key measures
- A Quality Health Scorecard rolling the picture up for leadership

Step-by-step

1. Select candidate metrics from the QA Metrics Catalogue and reject the vanity ones — starting with raw test-case and bug counts
2. Design the QA team dashboard for operational signals such as flakiness, environment stability and cycle time
3. Design the engineering leadership dashboard around escaped defects, change failure rate and delivery risk
4. Build the Executive Quality Dashboard so the CTO gets trend and business impact, not operational noise

5. Define each headline metric with the Metric Definition Template and assemble the Quality Health Scorecard

Submission format

Submit as a PDF or DOCX presenting the three dashboards, the definitions and the rationale.

How your work is assessed

If a QA lead reviewed this, they would look for:

- Metrics that measure outcomes and risk, not testing busyness
- Three genuinely different dashboards with a clear reason for each difference
- Precise metric definitions that would survive a challenge
- Vanity metrics identified and explicitly retired
- An executive view that supports a board conversation without misleading it

Templates & resources to use

- QA Metrics Catalogue — find it in the Resource Vault.
- Executive Quality Dashboard — find it in the Resource Vault.
- Metric Definition Template — find it in the Resource Vault.
- Quality Health Scorecard — find it in the Resource Vault.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Different audiences need different truths from the same data. If your executive dashboard and your team dashboard look the same, one of them is wrong — and counting test cases will tell no one whether Northstar is shipping safely.